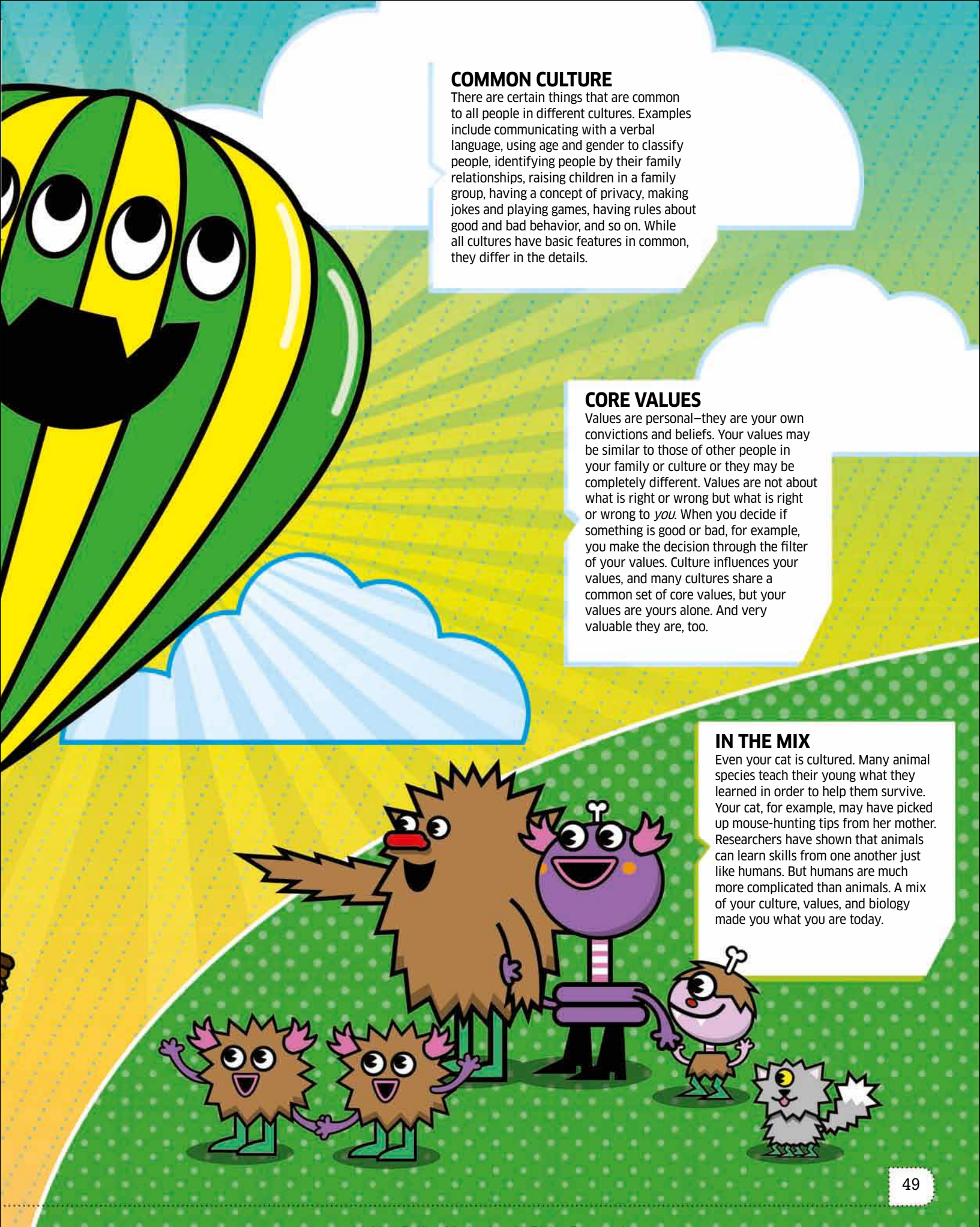




COMMON CULTURE

There are certain things that are common to all people in different cultures. Examples include communicating with a verbal language, using age and gender to classify people, identifying people by their family relationships, raising children in a family group, having a concept of privacy, making jokes and playing games, having rules about good and bad behavior, and so on. While all cultures have basic features in common, they differ in the details.

CORE VALUES

Values are personal—they are your own convictions and beliefs. Your values may be similar to those of other people in your family or culture or they may be completely different. Values are not about what is right or wrong but what is right or wrong to *you*. When you decide if something is good or bad, for example, you make the decision through the filter of your values. Culture influences your values, and many cultures share a common set of core values, but your values are yours alone. And very valuable they are, too.

IN THE MIX

Even your cat is cultured. Many animal species teach their young what they learned in order to help them survive. Your cat, for example, may have picked up mouse-hunting tips from her mother. Researchers have shown that animals can learn skills from one another just like humans. But humans are much more complicated than animals. A mix of your culture, values, and biology made you what you are today.